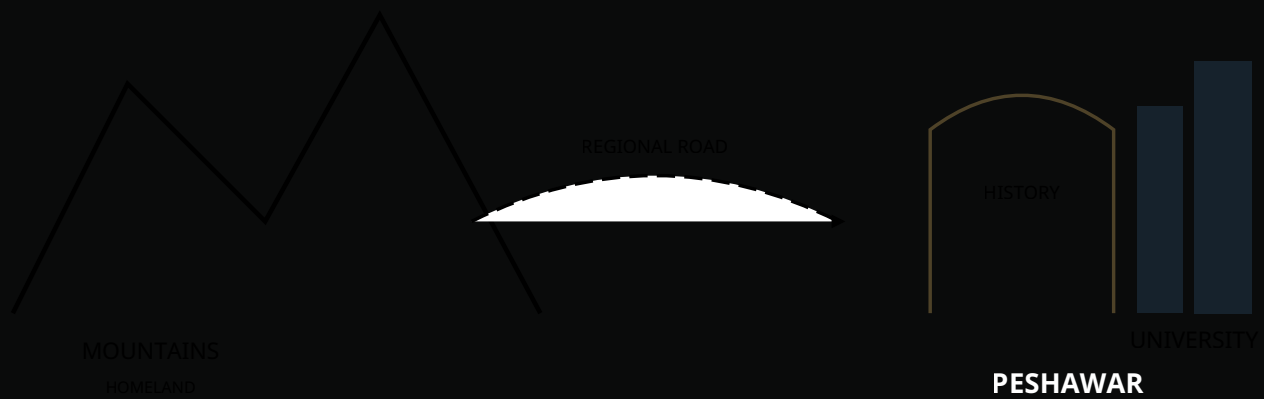


ORAKZAI IN PESHAWAR

“Between homeland, city, education and opportunity.”

Between the mountains of Orakzai and the wider world stands a city that has long connected people, markets, institutions and ideas. Peshawar is close enough to remain connected to the tribal districts, yet large enough to offer schools, universities, hospitals, markets, government offices and employment. For many people from the surrounding region, Peshawar is not simply a destination. It is a place of movement. People arrive to study. They come for work. Families travel for healthcare. Businesses connect with the city's markets. Young people build professional networks. Some stay. Others return home. For Orakzai families, Peshawar can therefore become part of a multi-local life: the homeland remains important while the city provides access to opportunities beyond the village or district. But the evidence must remain precise. The history of Peshawar is much larger than the history of Orakzai people in Peshawar. This page documents the connection without turning a broader urban history into an invented tribal narrative.



“The visual transition from the Orakzai highlands to the regional hub of Peshawar.”

WHAT IS PESHAWAR'S ROLE?

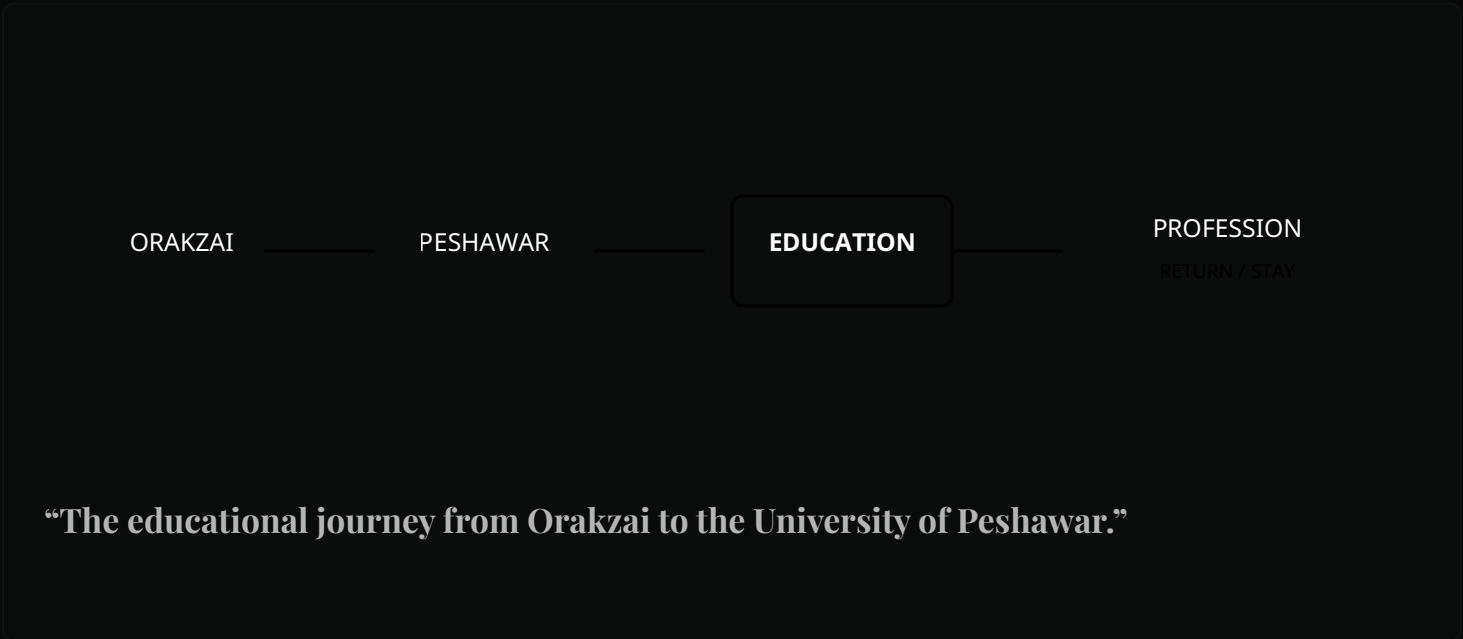
Peshawar functions as a multi-dimensional center for the Orakzai community. It is the primary site for higher education, specialized medical treatment, and high-volume commerce. For the Orakzai people, the city is not just a place to live; it is a vital resource that supplements the life of the district.^{3 4}



“The functional roles of Peshawar as a regional urban center.”

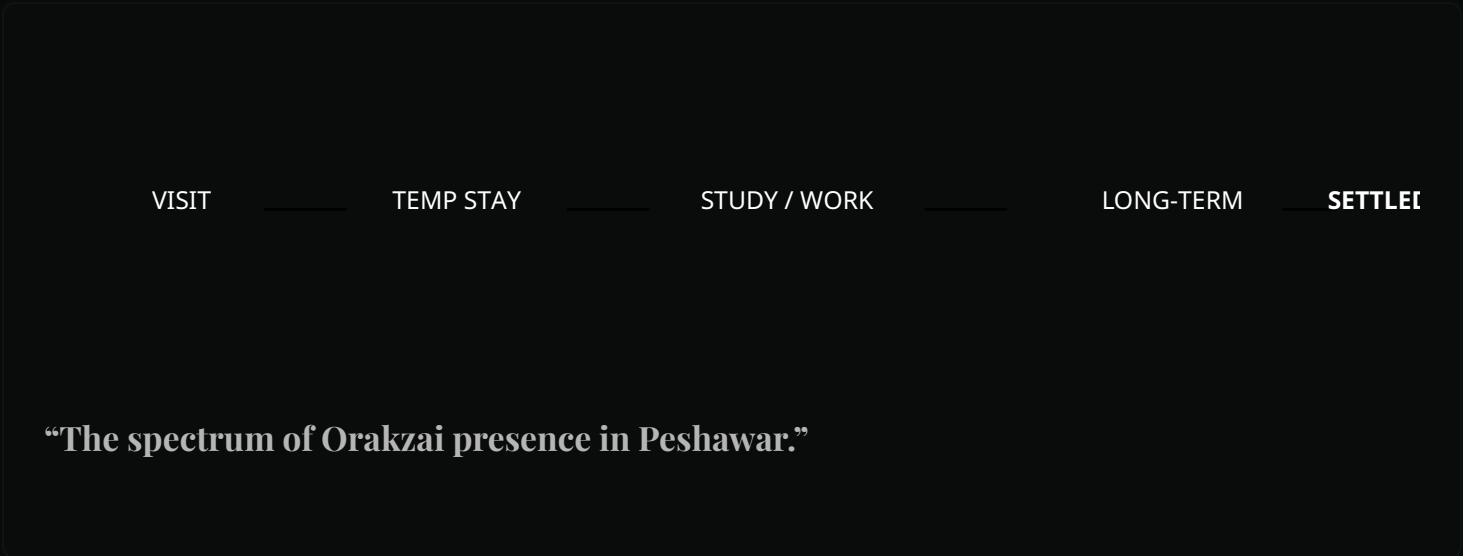
EDUCATION: THE UNIVERSITY CONNECTION

The University of Peshawar (UoP) stands as a beacon for Orakzai youth. For decades, students from the valleys have migrated to the city to pursue degrees in psychology, geology, political science, and medicine. This educational mobility creates a professional class that maintains deep ties to the homeland while navigating the urban intellectual landscape.³

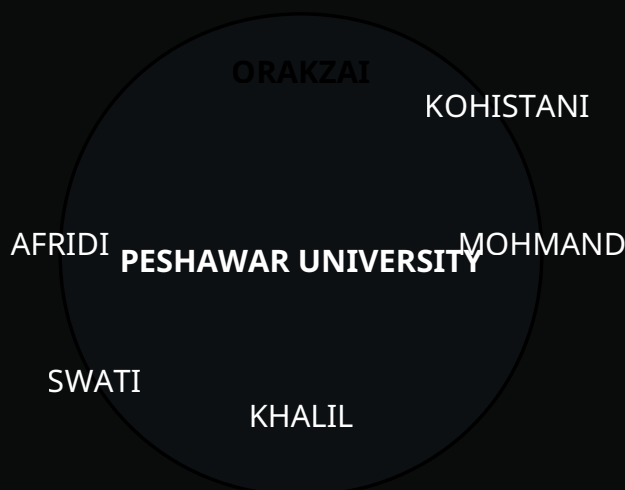


TEMPORARY VS. PERMANENT PRESENCE

Not every Orakzai resident in Peshawar is a permanent migrant. The city accommodates a spectrum of presence, from day-visitors seeking medical care to students on multi-year stays, and families who have established multi-generational roots in urban neighborhoods.¹



Peshawar's university and commercial environments act as melting pots where Orakzai individuals interact with Pashtuns from other tribal districts. This "urban tribal network" fosters a shared identity as residents of the frontier, while maintaining specific clan and family connections.⁴



“The synthesis of tribal identities within the urban educational environment.”

AUTHOR'S REFLECTION

Peshawar is the city where Orakzai meets the world. It is the place where a young student from a remote valley in Upper Orakzai first sits in a lecture hall alongside peers from Peshawar, Swat, and Khyber. It is where our elders seek the best medical care and where our entrepreneurs build their futures. But even in the heart of Hayatabad or the busy markets of Karkhano, the Orakzai heart remains connected to the mountains. We are not lost in the city; we are expanded by it. Peshawar provides the tools—the education, the healthcare, the business networks—but the purpose remains the same: to live with dignity and to honor the roots that reach back to our valleys.

